to Baldwin, who shows his surprise.) If Gresham doesn't go to jail, he'll start in business again, won't he? And he can't offer you anything less than a partnership.

BALDWIN: A partnership?

JOHN: (*with meaning*)With the hundred thousand capital you could put in the business, Dad.

BALDWIN: John!(*looks appealingly from one face to another; they are averted then*) You – you want me to take this money? (*There is no answer.*) Say 'Yes' one of you. (*still no answer*) or 'No'. (*a long pause*) I couldn't go into partnership with Gresham.

MARTHA: (*promptly*) Why not?

BALDWIN: People wouldn't trust him.

JOHN: Then you could go into business with someone else. Dad, a hundred thousand is a lot of money.

BALDWIN: (*walks to the window. looks out*) God knows I never thought this day would come! I know–I know no matter how you try to excuse it – I know that if I take this money I do a dishonourable thing. And you know it! You, and you, and you! All of you! Come, admit it!

JOHN: (*resolutely*) Nobody'll ever hear of it.

BALDWIN: But amongst ourselves, John! Whatever we are to the world, let us be honest with each other, the four of us! Well? *(His glance travels from John to Evie, whose head is bowed; from her to his wife, who is apparently busy with her knitting. He raises Martha's head; looks into her eyes. He shudders.)* **Shams**! Liars! **Hypocrites**! Thieves! And I no better than any of you! We have seen our souls naked, and they stink to Almighty Heaven! Well, why don't you answer me?

Let's understand better:

Baldwin grows ashamed of the greed of his family. John has the courage to look at him straight in the eye. He compels Baldwin to accept the money offered by Gresham.

MARTHA: (*feebly*) It's not wrong, Robert.

BALDWIN: It's not right.

JOHN: (*facing him steadily*) A hundred thousand is a lot of money, Dad.

BALDWIN: (*nodding slowly*)You can look into my eyes now, my son, can't you?

JOHN: (*without moving*) Dad, why did you refuse? Wasn't it because you were afraid of what we'd say?

BALDWIN: [*after a long pause*] Yes, John.

JOHN: Well, nobody will ever know it.

BALDWIN: Except the four of us.

JOHN: Yes, Father.

(*Abruptly they separate. Evie weeps in silence. Martha, being less emotional, blows her nose noisily and fumbles with her knitting. John scowls out of the window, and Baldwin, near the fireplace, clenches and unclenches his hands) Someone's coming.*

Let's understand better:

Baldwin feels ashamed of himself too. Mr. Marshall, the President of the Third National, another bank, comes to his house to convey an important news.

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